PeakForm — Project Brief & Decision Log

Doc 01 of 08 · Version 1.0 · Portfolio project for a Fiverr "Next.js landing page" gig

0. How this document set works

There are eight documents. Read 01–06 once, front to back. Use 08 in a UI design tool *before* any code. Then run the prompts in 07 one at a time.

#	Document	Job
01	Project Brief & Decision Log (this doc)	What we're building, why, and every decision with its reason
02	Design System	Exact tokens: colors, type, spacing, components, ban list
03	UI Design Spec	Section-by-section layout (mobile + desktop), UX rules, design↔code map
04	Content & Images	All final copy, config data, and the image shopping list
05	Technical Spec	Stack, folders, `site-config.ts` types, coding rules, AI rules file
06	Build Plan & QA	Order of work, quality gates, ship checklist
07	Build Prompts	Copy-paste prompts, one per step
08	UI Generator Prompt	One prompt for a UI design tool

Source-of-truth order (when two documents disagree): 02 (tokens) > 03 (layout) > 04 (copy) > 05 (code rules) > the generated design file > the AI's own preferences. A design tool's output never overrides Doc 02; if the generated design uses a different color or font, Doc 02 wins and the design file is corrected.

1. Goal

Build one landing page that does two jobs at once:

1. **Look and work like a real coaching business site**, so a Fiverr buyer who is a coach or trainer thinks "I want that."
2. **Be a reusable template**, so one `site-config.ts` file reskins it for a yoga studio, dental clinic, or restaurant in about two hours. That turns one project into three or four portfolio pieces.

The site itself is the product. It is not a real business. All people, numbers and testimonials are labeled sample content.

2. Two audiences (this matters for every decision)

- **The site's visitor** is a busy adult who wants to get stronger and is deciding whether to book an intro call. The site must convince *them*.
- **The Fiverr buyer** is a coach or gym owner scrolling your gig gallery. They judge in about five seconds from a thumbnail and a short screen recording. The site must also convince *them* that you have taste, can ship, and write real copy.

The design therefore needs a distinctive, instantly recognizable look (so the thumbnail stands out) *and* good everyday UX (so the demo survives being clicked through).

3. Positioning

- **Brand:** PeakForm
- **Coach (fictional):** Marcus Hale, 11 years coaching
- **Niche:** online strength coaching for busy adults over 30
- **Promise:** three sessions a week, about 45 minutes each, built around your schedule, your joints and the gym you actually have
- **Voice:** direct, plain-spoken, a little dry. Short sentences, concrete numbers, no hype

4. Scope

In scope: 12 sections, in this order

1. Sticky navbar with mobile menu and CTA
2. Hero
3. Stats strip
4. Programs (four)

5. About the coach
6. Client results
7. Pricing (three tiers)
8. Testimonials
9. FAQ (six questions)
10. Final CTA
11. Contact / intro-call form
12. Footer

Plus: SEO metadata, dynamic Open Graph image, sitemap, robots, favicon, README.

Out of scope (do not add, even if the AI suggests it)

Blog, CMS, dark mode, multi-page routing, authentication, payments, newsletter popups, chatbots, cookie banners with fake consent logic, image carousels, parallax, video backgrounds, i18n.

5. Definition of done

The project is finished when all of these are true:

- Live on a public URL, with a public or private GitHub repo
- Lighthouse (mobile) 90+ in Performance, Accessibility, Best Practices and SEO
- No horizontal scroll at 360, 375, 768, 1280 and 1536 px
- Every button and link goes somewhere real; the form delivers a real email to you
- Changing only `site-config.ts` (and swapping photos) produces a convincingly different brand
- Passes the anti-AI audit in Doc 06
- README lets a stranger set it up in under ten minutes
- Portfolio assets exist: desktop and mobile screenshots, a Lighthouse screenshot, and a 30–60 second scroll recording

6. Constraints

- **Zero budget.** Free tiers only: Vercel Hobby, GitHub, Web3Forms free (250 submissions/month), Unsplash/Pexels images, Google Fonts, Figma free
- **Solo builder, beginner-friendly.** Fewer dependencies beats cleverness

- **Timeline:** about 4 working days

7. Honest limitations

- The testimonials, stats, client results and prices are **fictional sample content**. The page carries a small "Sample content" note, and the README says so. Never present them to a Fiverr buyer as real clients
- Photos come from free stock libraries. Free stock licenses cover commercial use but give no model release for implying endorsement of a product. That is fine for a portfolio sample; real client sites must use the client's own photos
- Web3Forms' free plan only accepts submissions from the **browser**, not from a server, so the form posts client-side with a public access key (see decision 11)

8. Decision log

Every decision below is final for v1. The "rejected" column records what was considered, so no one re-litigates it mid-build.

#	Decision	Why	Rejected
1	**Niche: strength coaching for busy adults 30+**	A specific audience reads as a real business and makes copy concrete. Fitness buyers on Fiverr are plentiful and visual	"Generic fitness website" (forgettable); yoga (smaller buyer pool)
2	**Name: PeakForm; coach Marcus Hale**	Short, pronounceable, works as a wordmark, no obvious trademark conflict	Names with "Elite", "Pro", "Fit" prefixes (generic)
3	**Visual concept: "training logbook"**: numbered sets, mono labels, ruled lines, tabular numbers	It is memorable, fits the domain, and is cheap to build with type and borders alone. It also avoids the generic AI look	Dark with neon lime (cliché); purple/blue gradient SaaS look; glassmorphism

#	Decision	Why	Rejected
4	**Light warm "bone" base with ink (near-black) sections**	Alternating light and dark sections gives rhythm without gradients. Warm off-white feels premium and human	Pure white (clinical); all-dark (hides weak photos, low differentiation)
5	**One accent: signal orange `#FF4B1F`, always paired with ink text**	White text on this orange fails contrast; ink text on it passes. One accent keeps the page disciplined	Multiple accents; gradients
6	**All photos shown in black-and-white via one CSS treatment**	Stock photos from different shoots look inconsistent in color; monochrome makes them cohesive and lets the orange be the only color. A config flag lets other niches turn it off	Per-photo color grading; AI-generated photos
7	**Only 3 photos; no stock faces as "testimonial authors"**	Fewer images means faster loading and fewer mismatches. Fake faces on testimonials are a well-known fake-site tell and look deceptive	Avatar photos; photo gallery section
8	**"Client results" uses data cards, not before/after body photos**	Before/after photos from stock are fake by definition, are an ethical and advertising-rules risk (typical-results claims), and cannot be consistent. Numbers (start → now) are credible and easier to build	Stock before/after images

#	Decision	Why	Rejected
9	**Sharp corners, hairline borders, no shadows, left-aligned asymmetric layouts**	Rounded-2xl + shadow + centered text is the default AI look. Square, ruled, left-aligned layouts feel editorial	Rounded cards; centered hero
10	**FAQ uses native `<details>/<summary>`**	Accessible and keyboard-friendly by default, zero JavaScript	Custom accordion with state
11	**Form posts from the browser to Web3Forms with a public access key; honeypot + zod validation**	Web3Forms' free plan blocks server-to-server posting, so a Route Handler proxy would fail	Route Handler proxy; Formspree (50/month free); a fake form that only shows a success state
12	**Next.js 16 (App Router), TypeScript strict, Tailwind CSS v4, fully static output**	Current stable stack; static is the fastest and cheapest to host. Tailwind v4 keeps tokens in CSS	Pages Router; Tailwind v3 config files
13	**All content in `site-config.ts`; brand colors via CSS variables injected from config**	Makes the template reskinnable in hours. Content hardcoded in components defeats the purpose	Content inside JSX
14	**Fonts: Archivo (display), Instrument Sans (body), JetBrains Mono (labels)**	Strong, free, available through `next/font`, distinct from the default Inter-everywhere look	Inter for everything; Poppins
15	**Motion: one hero entrance plus CSS-only hover states; honor reduced-motion; no animation library**	"Everything fades up" is an AI tell. This changes my earlier suggestion of framer-motion: dropping it cuts bundle size and removes temptation	framer-motion; scroll-triggered reveals

#	Decision	Why	Rejected
16	**Validation: zod plus plain React state (no react-hook-form)**	One four-field form does not justify another dependency. This changes my earlier suggestion	react-hook-form
17	**Icons only where functional (arrow, menu, close, plus, check); no icon-in-a-square feature cards**	Icon tiles on every card are a leading AI tell. Typography and numbering do that job here	Icon for every program
18	**Pricing: middle tier highlighted by color inversion, not scale or glow**	Clear emphasis with no cheap effects	`scale-105`, glow, "Most popular" ribbon
19	**No dark mode, no carousels, no parallax**	Out of scope; each adds bugs and time	Theme toggle
20	**Hosting on Vercel Hobby for the portfolio demo**	Free and zero-config for Next.js. Check Vercel's current fair-use terms: Hobby is intended for personal, non-commercial use, which a portfolio demo is. Client deliveries should go on the client's own hosting account	Netlify / Cloudflare Pages (fine alternatives)
21	**Copy is written once, here, by hand, not generated at build time**	Specific, flawed-human copy is the single biggest "not AI" signal	Lorem ipsum; "unlock your potential" copy

9. Sync rules: keeping design and code identical

The design and the code drift apart when each is invented separately. To prevent that:

1. **One token set.** Doc 02 defines every color, size and spacing value. Doc 08 (the UI generator prompt) pastes those same values. The code reads the same names (`--color-ink` , `--color-accent` , and so on)
2. **One copy set.** The design tool receives the exact copy from Doc 04. The code reads it from `site-config.ts` . No one writes new text mid-build
3. **One section map.** Doc 03 lists every section with its component name and config key, so each frame in the design maps to one file in the code
4. **Design is reviewed against code.** After each section is built, compare a screenshot side by side with the design frame (Prompt step in Doc 07) and fix differences before moving on
5. **If the design tool invents something outside the spec**, either add it to Doc 02/03 first or delete it from the design. Never build something the docs don't describe

10. Optional 45-minute research (do this before the gig, not before the build)

The requirements here already reflect typical Fiverr landing-page buyers: mobile-friendly, fast delivery, working contact form, basic SEO, and clear communication. To confirm them for your own gig:

1. Search Fiverr for "Next.js landing page" and "fitness coach website". Open the top ten gigs
2. For each, note the package contents, delivery time, price, and what recent reviews praise or complain about
3. Write down any request that shows up three or more times (for example "source code included" or "SEO setup") and make sure your gig covers it
4. Save two or three real coach sites you like in a folder, with one line on what you like about each. Use them as mood references for the design tool in Doc 08